

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 14 Handout — A PR without a description is a mystery novel whose murderer is 'I was in a hurry'

2 - Azure Repos & Git Mastery · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — PR as a product (Azure Repos Git)

Piece	Field / location	Lab value
Source → target	feature/* → main	Never PR into a random long-lived branch
Title	Conventional: docs: / feat: / fix:	Matches commit intent
Description	.azuredevops/pull_request_template.md	What / Why / Test plan / Risk
Work item link	AB#123 in description or Development link	Day 7 User Story
Reviewers	Required reviewers (Day 19 policy)	Yourself is OK on a personal org
Checks	Build validation later (YAML)	None yet — still review the diff
Merge type	Squash (ADR Day 12)	Avoid merge commit spaghetti in this lab

Architecture B — review etiquette (decide what blocks merge)

Finding	Block the PR?	Comment style
Secret / PAT / sub ID	Yes	Do not paste the secret again; rotate
Wrong default target	Yes	Change target to main
Missing work item	Yes after Day 19 policy	Link AB# now even if policy is off
Nit: extra newline	No	Nit: prefix; do not hold merge
Unrelated refactor	Yes if it hides the actual change	Split PR
No test plan in template	Yes for this series	Tick local build / what you ran

Architecture C — pitfalls that rubber-stamp main

Pitfall	What you see	Fix
Empty template	PR body is the file headings only	Fill What/Why; delete unused sections
Complete without review	Set auto-complete + ignore comments	Read Files tab; comment on the hunk
Link to a work item on another project	AB# does not resolve	Use azure-100-labs IDs
PR from main to main	Empty diff	Always branch first
Screenshot of work board	Employer story titles in the PR	Personal org only; no work attachments
Force-complete with failures (later)	Red YAML ignored	Day 19 build validation required

One-liner to remember

A PR without a description is a mystery novel where the murderer is 'I was in a hurry'.

Step-by-step lab (personal Azure / Azure DevOps only)

Personal azure-100-labs. Add a PR template, open a real PR, link a work item. No employer reviewers.

- 1 `git switch main` && `git pull` && `git switch -c feature/day14-pr-template`
- 2 Create `.azuredevops/pull_request_template.md` with What / Why / Test plan / Risk (see code).
- 3 `git add .azuredevops/pull_request_template.md` && `git commit -m "docs: add pull request template"` && `git push -u origin feature/day14-pr-template`
- 4 Azure Repos → Pull requests → New pull request → source `feature/day14-pr-template` → target `main`.
- 5 Confirm the template auto-fills. Complete What/Why. Link a Day 7 User Story (Development / work items).
- 6 Files tab → self-review: title, description, no secrets. Add one comment on the markdown if you want the muscle memory.
- 7 Complete with squash merge (if allowed) or leave open until Day 19 policies. Delete source branch on complete.

.azuredevops/pull_request_template.md

```
## What
-

## Why
-

## Test plan
- [ ] Local `git status` clean on the branch
- [ ] Linked work item (AB#)
- [ ] No `.env`, PAT, or subscription GUID in the diff

## Risk
- Low / Med / High
```

Done checklist

- PR template exists under `.azuredevops/`
- Opened a PR into `main` with What/Why filled
- Work item linked (AB# or Development link)
- Self-reviewed the Files tab; no secrets

Tomorrow — Day 15

Advanced Git